

Magic Quadrant for B2B Marketing Automation Platforms

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B2B marketing automation platforms (MAPs) enable marketing teams to manage demand generation programs for leads and accounts and orchestrate customer engagement. CMOs can leverage this research to assess market maturity and AI innovations and to identify optimal vendors for strategic growth.

Market Definition/Description

Gartner defines B2B marketing automation platforms (B2B MAPs) as software applications that support demand generation processes at scale. B2B MAPs help marketers capture and qualify leads and accounts, orchestrate multichannel engagement across the full customer journey, and use analytics to optimize and measure performance.

B2B MAPs enable marketers to automate a wide range of activities intended to drive new customer acquisition, retention and growth. To support the pursuit of new commercial opportunities (from current or prospective customers), marketers use B2B MAPs to generate, prioritize and manage contacts, leads and account buying groups across the revenue life cycle. This includes the distribution of marketing-generated qualified leads to sales teams for further pursuit.

In addition, B2B MAPs are used to personalize, orchestrate and measure multichannel customer engagement campaigns and programs, often employing generative and agentic AI. B2B MAPs enable marketers to design and activate some communications channels natively —

most notably, email and web landing pages — and orchestrate customer engagement through other channels via integrations with other tools/platforms.

Lastly, marketers use B2B MAPs as a tool for collecting, analyzing and reporting performance analytics. Performance analytics enable both tactical measurement, such as marketing channel and content engagement metrics, and strategic measurement, such as the attribution of marketing activities to commercial outcomes.

B2B MAPs are optimized for B2B marketing use cases. They may also be applicable to B2C organizations selling high-consideration products with lead management needs or B2B2C models.

Mandatory Features

- Audience management for leads, accounts and buying groups
- Workflow and journey orchestration
- Lead and account scoring
- Email marketing
- Multichannel marketing
- Data ingestion and activation, profile unification
- Measurement and reporting
- Generative and agentic AI (e.g., content or journey creation)

Optional Features

- Agent studio to manage out-of-the-box and custom AI agents across their life cycle
- Consumption pricing management
- Multitouch attribution
- Composable platform

Magic Quadrant

Figure 1: Magic Quadrant for B2B Marketing Automation Platforms



Magic Quadrant for B2B Marketing Automation Platforms



Gartner

Vendor Strengths and Cautions

Act-On Software

Act-On Software is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. Its marketing automation is a stand-alone application focused on orchestrating marketing across the customer life cycle. Its clients are midmarket companies in financial services, manufacturing and professional services. Act-On Software provides an out-of-the-box agent to interact with visitors on a

customer's website. It does not manage and build agents and does not require consumption credits for AI.

Act-On Software's roadmap is focused on managing data for AI automation and insights as well as on developing industry-specific workflows and metrics for key verticals. Recent releases include the ability to create dynamic, rule-based or manual, static segments; and enhanced performance analytics with a conversational interface.

Strengths

- **Flexible integration:** Act-On distinguishes itself by providing clients with the option to select and integrate their preferred CRM. By prioritizing ease of use, this flexibility appeals to lean teams who may have limited access to technology support.
- **Information accuracy:** To ensure clients base their decisions on accurate information, Act-On deployed True Open detection to filter false email clicks and opens generated by security and privacy bots. Recognizing that AI requires proper context for its actions, Act-On also launched a customer knowledge layer to prevent AI misinformation.
- **Multi-instance architecture:** Act-On provides a multi-instance architecture that allows multibrand or multiregion organizations to share brand-approved campaign journeys and templates to local partners while maintaining central compliance and reporting. In addition to supporting centralized marketing within an organization, this technology supports franchises and distributor networks.

Cautions

- **Platform innovation delays:** The remainder of Act-On's 2026 development resources are heavily dedicated to rebuilding UIs and resolving dated user experiences, such as outbound email drafting, basic triggered email reporting and individual contact cards. Marketing teams looking for advanced product innovation may find that Act-On lags other vendors in this research in delivering fundamental platform capabilities.
- **Operational readiness for AI adoption:** Act-On's AI capabilities are designed to reduce manual effort through automated content collection, conversational guardrails and reporting that supports human oversight within customers' existing governance frameworks. However, organizations may still need to evaluate the quality, accessibility and governance of their data to realize the full benefits. Although upcoming capabilities are intended to broaden the tools available for personalized marketing, customers should

assess their internal readiness to manage, review and operationalize AI-driven workflows as these capabilities evolve.

- **Potential enterprise mismatch:** Enterprise buyers should validate whether Act-On's midmarket focus and emphasis on simplicity can support complex, global deployments requiring advanced governance, scalability and integrations. They should also assess Act-On's long-term product roadmap and enterprise support to reduce potential mismatch risk between Act-On's market focus and their strategic requirements.

Adobe

Adobe is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. Its B2B MAP solution comprises Adobe Marketo Engage, Adobe Marketo Optimizer, Adobe Journey Optimizer B2B Edition and Adobe Real-Time CDP B2B Edition. The solution is focused on optimizing personalized engagement with leads, accounts and buying groups across the entire B2B customer life cycle. Its clients span midsize and enterprise organizations across industries, including high tech, professional services and financial services. Its out-of-the-box agents include a workflow agent using AI decisioning for marketing campaign orchestration and a data agent for program quality assurance, lead import and data standardization.

Adobe's roadmap, which includes an agent studio to build and manage agents, is focused on autonomous AI agents and buying-group orchestration. Its Model Context Protocol (MCP) server supports custom agent development with MAP data. AI agent usage requires AI tokens beyond those included in each package.

Strengths

- **Co-worker workflow innovation:** Adobe integrates its B2B marketing platform capabilities with Adobe CX Enterprise Coworker to provide capabilities to orchestrate campaign tasks across Marketo Engage and Journey Optimizer B2B Edition. This conversational collaboration allows marketing teams and agents to jointly author goal-directed workflows, streamlining complex operational work.
- **Agentic framework with MCP server:** Marketo Engage MCP Server exposes 100+ marketing platform capabilities to external AI tools and partners through secure operations. This framework enables customers to build custom agents, orchestrate agentic workflows and execute campaign actions outside of the Adobe ecosystem while fully preserving established database permissions and governance.

- **Built-in data governance:** Marketo Engage enhances data ingestion and activation through callable agents triggered via webhooks directly inside smart campaign flow steps. These agents normalize data, enrich missing fields and suppress bots before the lead ever enters nurture or routing.

Cautions

- **Opaque line-item pricing:** Adobe does not publish a detailed, publicly accessible price sheet for Marketo Engage or Journey Optimizer B2B Edition. This lack of transparent line-item pricing, combined with a profile volume database model and credit-based consumption limits for AI, complicates budgeting and cost evaluations for customers.
- **Complex Adobe Marketo Measure implementation:** Gartner clients indicate that realizing value from multitouch attribution with Marketo Measure can require substantial effort. Aligning attribution models across disparate data sources often requires significant configuration effort, technical expertise and ongoing management, which may hinder adoption of Marketo Measure's advanced attribution capabilities.
- **Expanding product focus:** Journey Optimizer B2B Edition and Marketo Optimizer are the focal points for new journey orchestration and buying-group engagement capabilities. Organizations relying primarily on Marketo Engage may find that access to some of Adobe's newest orchestration and buying-group innovations increasingly requires the purchase of Journey Optimizer B2B Edition or Marketo Optimizer.

BUSINESSNEXT

BUSINESSNEXT is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. Its BUSINESSNEXT product suite comprises AGENTNEXT, WORKNEXT and DATANEXT. It is focused on vertical-specific marketing automation natively built on a unified CRM data model. Its clients are midsize and large enterprises within financial services, insurance, travel and healthcare. BUSINESSNEXT has a sophisticated agent tool to build and manage agents and does not require consumption credits for AI. It provides out-of-the-box agents that automate audience segmentation, personalization, scoring, journey creation and cross-channel campaigns.

BUSINESSNEXT's roadmap includes a fully autonomous operating platform. Recent investments focus on deploying private small language models (SLMs) for data sovereignty and pivoting to a headless agentic AI architecture.

Strengths

- **Market responsiveness:** BUSINESSNEXT has rapidly adapted to market demands by offering private SLMs to address strict data privacy, compliance and lower total cost of ownership (TCO) needs in heavily regulated sectors. Its headless agentic AI architecture enables autonomous agents to bypass front-end interfaces and execute campaigns directly across external systems via open protocols like MCP.
- **Financial services focus:** The platform features preconfigured data models, regulatory workflows and native support for distributed physical channels, such as branch-as-a-channel, allowing retail banking and insurance providers to bridge offline branch operations at scale with digital campaigns.
- **Agentic innovation:** Transitioning from traditional journey builders, BUSINESSNEXT provides cooperative multiagent orchestration. Marketers can deploy out-of-the-box agents for segmentation, personalization and journey optimization that autonomously collaborate, analyze real-time intent signals and adapt workflows under human-in-the-loop controls.

Cautions

- **North American geographic coverage:** BUSINESSNEXT's customer base is highly concentrated in APAC and EMEA. It has very limited traction and directly supported customers in North America and lacks certified implementation partners or system integrators there.
- **Inflexible and opaque price plans:** Not only is there no publicly available pricing on its website, but subscription rates are for five-year terms, uncommon in this fast-changing market. Pricing varies for cloud-hosted and on-premises versions of the platform, with a minimum of 100 users.
- **Increased IT dependency:** BUSINESSNEXT now supports hosting private SLMs and large language models (LLMs) on secure on-premises servers, which makes internal IT responsible for server maintenance and model deployment. This change can cause delays and bottlenecks, limiting marketing's ability to quickly launch campaigns and reducing overall agility in competitive markets.

Creatio

Creatio is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. Creatio's product suite comprises Creatio Marketing, Creatio Marketing AI Agents, Creatio Business Studio and Creatio AI Studio. It

focuses on accelerating the lead-to-revenue cycle using marketing agentic workflows.

Creatio's clients tend to be midsize and large enterprises in financial services, manufacturing and professional services. Its out-of-the-box agents identify look-alike audiences and growth opportunities.

Creatio's roadmap includes enhanced autonomous marketing and closed-loop campaign optimization. Its Creatio AI Studio manages agents, requiring AI consumption credits per run and per agent. Recent product updates include autonomous orchestration of AI marketing campaigns and AI-powered next best channel and content for engagement. Its AI packages are available with tiers of yearly credits, with the option to purchase additional credits.

Strengths

- **Consumption packaging for enterprises:** Creatio's Unlimited Enterprise plan offers a flat annual subscription that is based on company scale, not the number of users or marketing contacts. Marketers looking for enterprisewide AI adoption with budget predictability and flexible consumption options without the licensing complexity of traditional SaaS models can consider Creatio's alternate business model.
- **No-code AI agents:** Creatio's Twin release introduced AI-assisted no-code tools that embed conversational agent design into its CRM platform. Its retrieval-augmented generation and multimodal capabilities allow customers to intuitively build and deploy agents without requiring deep technical expertise.
- **User-driven UI enhancements:** Creatio has redesigned its scoring and filter UI based directly on customer feedback. This targeted update enables nontechnical marketers to build and manage campaigns with greater independence from technical resources.

Cautions

- **Scaling costs:** Pricing for Creatio's entry-level, seat-based plan carries high per-user list costs, which can lead to higher overall costs as deployments scale. Further, once organizations exhaust the AI package baseline limit, they must buy additional AI credit blocks.
- **Cross-system integration complexity:** CMOs should note that Creatio's end-to-end platform loses its unified data model advantages when connecting to external CRMs, making it less suited for the operational complexity of large organizations. This can increase data and integration management overhead and may affect the effectiveness of AI-driven insights and automation.

- **Standard support constraints:** Creatio's standard support package restricts high-priority response times to four hours and limits organizations to only two authorized contacts. Customers needing faster issue resolution face increased costs, as paid support tiers require a 10% to 20% premium on top of base subscription fees.

HCLSoftware

HCLSoftware is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. Its HCL Unica+ suite unifies customer data with its customer data platform (CDP) and manages cross-channel campaigns with orchestrated journeys and governed AI. Its clients are large enterprises in highly regulated industries such as financial services, healthcare and telecommunications. HCL expanded its out-of-the-box AI agents with six additions, including campaign creation and journey orchestration agents, and enhanced its real-time personalization capabilities for email and landing pages.

HCL's roadmap includes campaign generation from a marketing brief, automated quality checks, the addition of MCP servers and a tool to build custom agents. It provides agents that build audience segments and manage privacy, and its packages include AI tokens with the option to buy more.

Strengths

- **Vision for AI compliance:** HCL integrates AI directly into products that people use and coordinate through shared signals, a common data and identity layer, named human owners and a full audit trail, rather than making it a separate application. This approach helps risk-averse enterprises overcome security and compliance challenges by enabling organizations to enforce rules and prevent AI models from overriding them.
- **On-premises delivery:** HCL's AI-capable platform stands out for its on-premises delivery mode. This provides highly regulated companies the latest capabilities such as coordinating multistep agentic workflows and predictive scoring and propensity models without data ever leaving their environment.
- **Outcome-focused AI innovation:** MaxAI agents prioritize outcome-focused innovation to enhance customer experiences. The Optimize Agent streamlines contact policy management across campaigns, while the Segmentation Agent identifies optimal audience segments based on propensity and behavioral data, driving more effective marketing strategies.

Cautions

- **Regulated industry focus:** HCL's business is built on a small number of highly regulated industries with massive transaction requirements and data protection needs. This sharp focus means that outside a handful of specific industries, such as financial services, healthcare and telecommunications, this platform is unlikely to meet the use cases for every large enterprise.
- **High technical overhead:** HCL's reliance on flowchart-based architectures and custom coding means it is fundamentally built for highly technical users rather than everyday marketers. This shifts a massive technical and maintenance burden onto internal teams to build and preserve complex segmentations.
- **Complex pricing structure:** HCL Unica+ is offered in a variety of ways that include individual, bundled and legacy pricing, alongside separate tracking fees for audience profiles, email and messaging volumes, and AI tokens. With an enterprise price that sits in the middle of vendors evaluated in this research, this complexity, combined with a lack of published prices, could give buyers pause in considering this vendor.

HubSpot

HubSpot is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. Its Marketing Hub product delivers an easy-to-use, unified marketing platform natively built on its Smart CRM context layer to support lead management, journey orchestration and multichannel campaigns. It primarily serves small and midmarket companies in high tech, financial services, professional services and manufacturing. HubSpot provides out-of-the-box agents for content, customer service, prospecting and data, managed in Agent Hub. It requires consumption-based HubSpot credits for AI use.

HubSpot's roadmap includes expanding the Content Agent, which uses AI to draft content, such as social posts, and launching a Lead Nurture Agent to personalize content based on current context before sending. Recent investments focus on answer engine optimization (AEO) tools via the acquisition of XFunnel and native connectors for frontier LLMs.

Strengths

- **Inbound AI and AEO innovation:** HubSpot is an early AEO innovator following its acquisition of XFunnel, natively tracking brand visibility across major answer engines. Marketers can act directly on these visibility insights to generate citation-ready content and capture high-intent leads from emerging AI referral channels.

- **Unified data:** Built natively on a single-entity Smart CRM database, Marketing Hub eliminates the data silos and synchronization delays associated with middleware or external data warehouses. This unified context ensures that segmentation, personalization and closed-loop revenue attribution are executed from a single shared record.
- **Agentic interoperability:** HubSpot delivers a highly open agent ecosystem through its MCP server and native connectors for frontier LLMs like Claude and ChatGPT. This architecture allows both first-party agents and third-party external agents to securely operate HubSpot end to end using natural language and public APIs.

Cautions

- **Weak customer retention:** HubSpot has a significantly lower customer retention rate than competitor vendors in this Magic Quadrant, which raises long-term viability concerns for smaller buyer organizations. Because its high growth rate depends on aggressive new customer acquisition, buyers must evaluate capabilities beyond free versions to ensure their scale can be supported.
- **Scale limitations:** Despite upmarket pushes, HubSpot's customer base remains heavily concentrated among small businesses with low contact volumes compared to other Leaders evaluated in this research. Larger enterprise organizations must carefully evaluate the platform's support for complex end-to-end go-to-market processes, diverse channels and advanced personalization before committing.
- **High total cost of ownership:** While HubSpot mandates upfront onboarding, complex enterprise deployments may include an embedded HubSpot Solutions Architect as part of an optional co-delivery model. Additionally, upmarket transitions increase pricing across tiers and contact volume, while complex seat licensing and unpredictable Breeze AI credit consumption can strain budgets.

LeadSquared

LeadSquared is a Niche Player in this Magic Quadrant. Its LeadSquared Marketing Automation product provides marketing automation tightly integrated with sales execution and customer-facing field teams. It primarily serves small and midsize businesses and midmarket organizations across financial services, education and healthcare sectors. LeadSquared provides out-of-the-box agents to review and qualify leads and spot potential prospect dropouts. It lacks a dedicated visual agent tool to manage custom agents. A set quantity of AI

elements are included in each package, similar to email volume, and customers can purchase more if needed.

LeadSquared's roadmap targets prompt-driven workflow design, in-flow agent orchestration and deep verticalized compliance models. Recent investments focus on conversational analytics with its embedded, AI-powered assistant, AI propensity scoring to predict conversion probability and the Invorto AI voice platform acquisition.

Strengths

- **Enabling sales and marketing alignment:** LeadSquared unifies marketing automation with native sales execution, mobile field operations and digital portals on a single shared record. This unified architecture reduces handoff friction and data discrepancies between systems, allowing sales teams to track prospects from first inquiry to final conversion.
- **Voice AI innovation:** The integration of the Invorto AI conversational voice platform delivers multilingual, automated inbound and outbound qualification calling directly inside the CRM ecosystem. This native agentic voice capability captures structured call signals, scores lead intent and logs next best actions without the latency or integration costs of third-party telephony middleware.
- **Customer responsiveness:** LeadSquared has updated its platform in response to customer feedback for new features. Recent additions based on requests include AI-based lead distribution, verified email unsubscribes and AI-powered bot filtering for email analytics.

Cautions

- **Support and SLA restrictions:** LeadSquared operates customer support over email, chat and a portal, with responses limited to five days a week during business hours. Large enterprise organizations requiring 24/7 mission-critical coverage, proactive phone support or localized on-site assistance must negotiate custom premium SLA terms to ensure operational continuity.
- **APAC regional concentration:** The platform's customer base and certified implementation partner network remain concentrated within the APAC region. This could present service and scaling challenges for large global enterprises that need either on-site or in-region support.
- **Opaque pricing and packaging:** LeadSquared's subscription tiers lack public transparency regarding contract terms, add-on feature pricing and volume-based overage rates for

metered usage. Buyers must audit lower-tier packages to confirm that essential capabilities are not gated behind expensive upmarket upgrades.

Microsoft

Microsoft is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. Its Dynamics 365 Customer Insights orchestrates personalized journeys bundled with a CDP to build a 360-degree customer view. Microsoft's clients span small to large businesses in healthcare, financial services and manufacturing. It provides out-of-the-box AI capabilities including natural-language segmentation and AI-assisted content creation for emails and journeys.

Microsoft's roadmap includes Dynamics 365 AI Hub to configure, enable or disable AI agents; an outreach optimization agent; dynamic content blocks for emails; and an agent management tool. Recent updates include Microsoft Copilot-powered SMS, website-interaction-based segmentation, and form bot protection. Agents for outreach optimization and journey creation, as well as Copilot-powered SMS, require consumption credits.

Microsoft declined requests for supplemental information. Gartner's analysis is therefore based on other credible sources.

Strengths

- **FastTrack implementation program:** Microsoft supports deployments through its FastTrack program, providing access to Microsoft engineers and solutions architects to work alongside implementers. This approach is included as part of large enterprise deals at no additional cost, accelerating adoption and realizing value quicker.
- **Enhanced AI Adoption:** Organizations that are heavily invested in Microsoft technologies gain from unified data and the familiar Copilot interface, driving greater usage and adoption of AI within Customer Insights. This empowers marketing teams to make more data-driven decisions and enhances campaign effectiveness.
- **Microsoft ecosystem synergy:** Customer Insights benefits from deep integration across Microsoft applications, including Dynamics 365, Dataverse, Power BI and Copilot capabilities. Shared data, workflow automation and AI services help organizations connect sales, marketing and service processes within a unified technology ecosystem.

Cautions

- **Limited AI differentiation:** Several features that are generally available from other vendors in this research remain on the Dynamics 365 Customer Insights roadmap, such as send-time optimization and journey creation agent. As a result, the platform currently offers limited AI differentiation in areas where AI-powered assistants, agents and automation capabilities have become increasingly common.
- **Pricing for interacted people:** Customer Insights pricing includes capacity limits based on “interacted people” (e.g., contacts, leads, accounts or profiles interacted with both outbound and inbound), with additional usage requiring the purchase of capacity packs. Organizations with large audiences may need ongoing monitoring and planning to effectively manage costs.
- **Evolving journey orchestration depth:** Microsoft is advancing its journey orchestration capabilities through ongoing investments in AI-assisted planning, optimization and customer engagement. However, some advanced orchestration functionality, such as real-time decisioning and AI-driven next best action, that marketers commonly expect from mature MAP providers is still evolving, limiting the platform’s depth.

Oracle

Oracle is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. Its B2B marketing offering comprises Oracle Eloqua Marketing Automation, Oracle Fusion Marketing — including Fusion Unity Data Platform and Fusion Marketing Orchestration — and Oracle AI Agent Studio for Fusion Applications. The offering orchestrates marketing and sales processes by integrating campaign management, customer intelligence and AI agents to optimize business outcomes. Its clients tend to be large and midsize enterprises in professional services, financial services and high tech. AI Agent Studio is included with any Oracle Fusion product and can build and manage AI agents. Consumption-based pricing applies to premium AI actions, and there are no per-agent fees.

Oracle’s roadmap includes bringing AI Agent Studio capabilities directly into Eloqua and modernizing the suite’s core experiences. Recent product updates include a library of role-based marketing agents and teams of specialized agents owning end-to-end outcomes.

Strengths

- **Agentic AI architecture:** Oracle offers an agentic architecture featuring its AI Agent Studio and generally available role-based agents, such as a Buying Group Assistant. Its Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Supercluster and collaboration with NVIDIA provide customers with a fast, secure foundation for executing AI workloads.

- **Revenue-focused automation:** Oracle shifts the focus of marketing automation away from traditional engagement metrics toward tracking revenue outcomes. To support this strategy, Oracle uses unified business data, such as renewals, subscriptions, and product ownership, to power reliable, context-aware marketing actions.
- **Journey design:** Eloqua's Campaign and Program Canvases support complex enterprise journey design through unlimited branching, decisioning and looping across paid, earned and owned channels. Its ability to run multiple parallel scoring models per account helps marketers uncover cross-sell demand across broad portfolios.

Cautions

- **Diffuse product offering:** Oracle's marketing automation capabilities remain commercially fragmented, splitting core features across separate product lines like Eloqua, Unity Data Platform, and Fusion applications. Marketers looking for a unified, out-of-the-box MAP that delivers end-to-end intelligent orchestration under a single license may find Oracle's modular suite more complex to deploy.
- **Licensing complexity:** Oracle provides midmarket and enterprise pricing online as a searchable PDF, but it does not appear on its website. Furthermore, separate pricing vectors for Unity Data Platform profiles, sessions and Fusion Agentic Applications increase licensing complexity and make overall costs more difficult to estimate.
- **Absence of native AEO:** Eloqua does not provide out-of-the-box AEO tools or AI search visibility dashboards. While Oracle notes that users can manually manage web content accessible to search engines, the platform lacks built-in capabilities to track how brand content is cited across LLM answer engines or automatically generate content recommendations to close visibility gaps.

Salesforce

Salesforce is a Leader in this Magic Quadrant. Its Marketing Cloud solution comprises Marketing Cloud Next, Salesforce Personalization, Marketing Intelligence and Loyalty Management. The solution delivers agentic campaign creation, conversational journey orchestration and real-time segmentation. Marketing Cloud Next replaces Account Engagement for new B2B customers. It serves small and midsize businesses (SMB), midmarket, and enterprise companies across high tech, healthcare and life sciences, manufacturing, automotive, and financial and professional services industries. It provides out-

of-the-box agents with insights into buying-group engagement and campaign performance. Agentforce Studio manages agents.

Salesforce's roadmap includes Salesforce Headless 360 for Marketing Cloud, which will give external platforms and LLMs access to Salesforce data and workflows. Recent releases include conversational email that allows marketers to engage with buyers and unified customer engagement dashboards for sales, marketing and service. Packages include AI flex credits, with the option to purchase more.

Strengths

- **Core CRM architecture:** Salesforce rebuilt its marketing stack as part of its core CRM architecture for B2B organizations, expanding agentic offerings and improving access to customer data. This strengthens its full-funnel agentic orchestration by simplifying real-time personalization across the entire buyer's journey with account- and buying-group-specific content optimized for humans and LLMs.
- **Revenue-focused journey metrics:** As B2B marketers shift from demand generation to full-funnel revenue impact, Salesforce offers autonomous agents that respond to buying-group signals with personalized content. This change allows marketers to focus on significant journey metrics by reviewing pipeline velocity and closed revenue contribution with sales partners rather than debating lead quality.
- **Marketing team self-service enablement:** Salesforce released Marketing Objects — an in-app workspace to create, load and manage data without IT reliance — and Salesforce Go to streamline Marketing Cloud implementation. These help marketing operations teams manage their own resources and reduce the need for IT support.

Cautions

- **Future-focused marketing:** Salesforce's marketing focuses on an agentic view of the future, especially from its keynote stages. Legacy customers can gain access to agentic marketing capabilities from Account Engagement, but it requires a consumption-based pricing model and implementation of Data 360 (Salesforce's CDP), or the deployment of an additional marketing application.
- **Layered ecosystem implementation:** The Salesforce CRM platform can start simply and grow to be an expensive and extensive install. Marketing Cloud Next requires Data 360 to power its AI capabilities. While personalization, intelligence and loyalty applications are optional add-ons, their absence could limit the full capabilities offered in Marketing Cloud.

- **Target audience alignment:** Salesforce's sales motion targets sales and technology leaders, frequently pressuring the CMO with enterprise concerns. CMOs need to ensure that marketing use cases are fully addressed to prevent organizations from purchasing a complex B2B marketing platform based strictly on its IT security and CRM alignment.

Zoho

Zoho is a Challenger in this Magic Quadrant. Its Zoho CRM Plus and Zoho Marketing Plus enable marketing teams to secure more deals with sales. Zoho serves small businesses and midsize enterprises in financial services, high tech and professional services. It provides out-of-the-box agents that qualify leads and monitor deals.

Zoho's roadmap includes AI orchestration for lead generation, segmentation, journey mapping and qualification; enhanced buyer intelligence; and AI-powered best journey and channel recommendations. Recent updates include the ability to build custom agents; connecting LLMs to Zoho's APIs, data models and actions; and native ABM functionality. Zia Agent Studio manages agents. Zoho includes monthly agent tokens with the option to purchase more.

Strengths

- **Balanced geographic strategy:** Zoho has a well-distributed global customer base and a decentralized model that ensures localized execution and strict data sovereignty. It delivers direct sales and support across more than 25 countries and regional offices in Germany, Spain, Israel and Jordan. To meet regional compliance standards, Zoho operates local data centers in Dubai and Abu Dhabi.
- **Specialized industry solutions:** Zoho provides direct vertical solutions, like Zoho for Healthcare, and supports a network of over 50 healthcare partners. Furthermore, it enables retail customers to seamlessly conduct product scoring by offering native commerce integrations with Shopify, WooCommerce and Zoho Commerce.
- **Market adaptation:** To address shifting mailbox requirements, Zoho introduced email health dashboards, sender reputation monitoring and advanced bot filtering to safeguard deliverability. It also accelerated its privacy roadmap, prioritizing channel-level subscription preferences and consent-aware email tracking to help clients maintain compliance.

Cautions

- **Sales and service use cases:** Zoho's sales motions target sales and service leaders rather than CMOs, due to Zoho's higher maturity in serving those use cases over marketing use

cases. This can cause challenges for marketing leaders who must adopt a MAP that is part of an integrated platform already in place versus selecting from their own consideration set of vendors.

- **Functional gaps in channels:** Zoho's platform lacks several out-of-the-box advanced B2B marketing capabilities. It does not offer native AEO tools to manage brand visibility across AI answer engines nor does it support native programmatic ad targeting. Additionally, it lacks native AI agent decision making to dynamically recommend the next best channel for contacts or segments in campaign execution.
- **Restricted support availability:** Zoho provides standard support during weekday business hours per time zone with response times of up to six hours, which may fail to meet the mission-critical needs of all marketing operations teams. Premium and enterprise support, with in-country and embedded teams, provide shorter response times beyond business hours for the largest enterprises with additional fees.

Vendors Added and Dropped

We review and adjust our inclusion criteria for Magic Quadrants as markets change. As a result of these adjustments, the mix of vendors in any Magic Quadrant may change over time. A vendor's appearance in a Magic Quadrant one year and not the next does not necessarily indicate that we have changed our opinion of that vendor. It may be a reflection of a change in the market and, therefore, changed evaluation criteria, or of a change of focus by that vendor.

Added

- HCLSoftware

Dropped

- Freshworks
- SugarCRM

Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria

The inclusion criteria represent the specific attributes that Gartner analysts believe are necessary for inclusion in this research.

To qualify for inclusion, providers needed to demonstrate that they met the following criteria as of 30 June 2026:

- Delivered B2B MAP functionality primarily within a single product offering.
- Had at least 25 companies using its B2B marketing automation solution, including at least 10 companies with \$50 million+ in fiscal 2025 revenue and/or 100+ employees.
- Met one of the following conditions:
 - Had at least US\$50 million calendar year 2025 overall license revenue.
 - Had at least US\$25 million calendar year 2025 overall license revenue and at least 25 new companies as customers when compared to calendar year 2024.
 - Had at least US\$25 million calendar year 2025 overall license revenue and at least 10% revenue growth when compared to calendar year 2024.
- Demonstrated sales, customer support and partners in a minimum of two of the following four regions: North America, EMEA, Latin America, and Asia/Pacific.
- B2B MAP software must have offered functionality to support demand generation processes at scale with the ability to manage:
 - Audience of contacts, leads, accounts and buying groups
 - Workflow and journey orchestration
 - Lead and account scoring
 - Email marketing
 - Multichannel marketing
 - Data ingestion and activation
 - Measurement and reporting
 - Generative and agentic AI

Evaluation Criteria

Ability to Execute

This analysis evaluates vendors on the quality and efficacy of the processes, systems, methods or procedures that enable marketing provider performance to be competitive, efficient and effective. Vendors' operations must also positively impact revenue, retention and reputation within Gartner's view of the B2B marketing automation platform market.

Ability to Execute Evaluation Criteria	
<i>Evaluation Criteria</i>	<i>Weighting</i>
Product or Service	High
Overall Viability	High
Sales Execution/Pricing	Medium
Market Responsiveness/Record	High
Marketing Execution	NotRated
Customer Experience	High
Operations	NotRated

Source: Gartner (September 2026)

Completeness of Vision

Gartner analysts evaluate providers on their ability to convincingly articulate logical statements. This includes current and future market direction, innovation, customer needs,

competitive forces and how well they map to Gartner’s view of the B2B marketing automation platform market.

Completeness of Vision Evaluation Criteria	
<i>Evaluation Criteria</i>	<i>Weighting</i>
Market Understanding	High
Marketing Strategy	Medium
Sales Strategy	Medium
Offering (Product) Strategy	High
Business Model	Medium
Vertical/Industry Strategy	Low
Innovation	High
Geographic Strategy	Low

Source: Gartner (September 2026)

Quadrant Descriptions

Leaders

Leaders possess capabilities that enable them to provide deep support across nearly all B2B MAP solution requirements, generally separating themselves from other vendors most significantly across the following capabilities: email marketing, data ingestion and activation, and generative and agentic AI. They generally demonstrate the ability to address the needs of large enterprise clients. Leaders’ product roadmaps balance continued investments in agentic

AI with journey orchestration that aim to improve customer engagement and demand generation effectiveness and efficiency.

Challengers

Challengers offer functionalities across all of the assessed B2B MAP solution capabilities, but they may lack the depth of Leaders in certain places, particularly in terms of their ability to manage multichannel marketing. While they may show signals of innovation, they have not demonstrated commitment to meeting emerging market needs, including in ways to deliver content to AI answer engines.

Visionaries

Visionaries have a strong vision for delivering some of the more advanced B2B MAP capabilities, but this may happen at the expense of overall ease of use of the platform. They excel in offering emerging functionality, including advanced versions of agentic, generative and predictive AI, which can help shape the direction of how this market enables clients to optimize how they engage their customers. Their ability to execute may be hampered by less clarity in their go-to-market strategy in comparison to Leaders.

Niche Players

Niche Players satisfy the product requirements of B2B MAPs, often through a basic set of functions and generally to a narrower market segment in comparison to other vendors. Niche Players may excel in supporting clients of certain industries, certain geographic regions or small to midsize businesses. They typically lack the operations, partners, product capabilities or vision to expand their reach. Their limited functional capabilities' depth, in comparison to Leaders, could have its benefits, in that clients may enjoy a more simplified product experience.

Context

B2B MAPs and associated products serve as the primary means for orchestrating prospective and current customer engagement and managing demand generation operations for B2B marketing teams. All of the vendors evaluated in this Magic Quadrant offer the basic capabilities required by most low- to mid-maturity marketing teams.

B2B marketing automation platforms is a mature market, but it is not standing still. In the last few years, the market has experienced startling innovation driven by generative, predictive and agentic AI. Many AI features are pervasive across B2B MAP vendors, with more on the roadmap. For example, the inclusion of out-of-the-box agents and tools to build and manage custom agents is a major driver of innovation in this market.

This is a new era of buying. Buying technology today is less about evaluating the current platform features and meeting current use cases. It is more about agreeing with the vendor's vision, roadmap and approach to AI. Aligning with the midterm to long-term vision ensures the right vendor will lead the journey into the future. These factors played a role in how Gartner evaluated vendors in this Magic Quadrant.

Beyond finding differentiation in vendor offerings via product capabilities, a key source of vendor differentiation for this market will be how well each vendor's product(s), packaging and support ecosystem fit your organization's needs. Key considerations for assessing B2B MAP vendor fit include:

- The vendor's ability to integrate with other tools in your technology stack (most notably, your sales force automation (SFA)/CRM provider) or the vendor's additional marketing, CRM or data technologies, measured in terms of feasibility, level of effort and any associated costs.
- The vendor's ability to satisfy your predefined use cases. Developing predefined B2B MAP use cases is a non-negotiable task for effective vendor evaluation and selection (see [Toolkit: B2B Marketing Technology Use Case Builder](#)).
- The vendor's ability to support customized product implementation via self-service modes, customer success programs included in product licensing fees, professional services for an additional cost and/or the vendor's network of third-party implementation partners. However, marketing teams with limited resources and/or access to in-house technical expertise may prefer vendors that can satisfy basic product requirements out of the box, with minimal effort required.

The evaluation conducted in this Magic Quadrant focuses on how vendors can serve dominant B2B marketing use cases that are broadly applicable across marketing teams of varying levels of maturity, size, complexity and industry vertical.

Market Overview

B2B marketing teams and leaders are under pressure to perform. Whether successful performance is defined as increased pipeline, growing revenue or ongoing business transformation, AI is part of every CMO's current responsibilities at some level. In a 2026 Gartner survey of B2B CMOs, 59% responded that their top strategic priority is effectively integrating AI into marketing programs and strategies. ¹

Rather than approaching this critical task of incorporating AI into marketing activities from a blank slate, CMOs will find that exploring AI capabilities within the context of known technology will make it easier. How were lead scoring models created before? How were campaign journeys built and orchestrated before? Building upon the strategy underlying those activities will help define the use cases and needs of both the technology and AI.

AI is disrupting every enterprise technology category, including MAPs. Capabilities announcements, enhancements and releases are coming faster than ever. CMOs must evaluate whether this rapid evolution is really a revolution and if this is an example of enterprise software on its way out. For most organizations, the need for maintenance, support, partner ecosystems and ongoing development means that buying software is still a better option than coding a MAP from scratch with AI.

The question, though, is which platform meets the current and future needs of CMOs. Besides the platforms evaluated in this Magic Quadrant, there are two new platforms that show where the market is going:

- The founding team behind Bizible started Inflection in 2020. It relaunched in 2025 as an AI-native platform with agents, MCP support, prompt-driven campaign creation, and life cycle orchestration.
- The other platform is Phave, an AI-native orchestration platform from Marketo co-founder Jon Miller. Instead of using rule-based logic, Phave uses AI reasoning to dynamically orchestrate one-to-one customer journeys. It is expected to launch in general availability in Fall 2026.

Both platforms have enterprise customers, but do not meet the requirements to be included in this Magic Quadrant. They were included in this market overview because they show a shift in paradigm. They are AI-native and account-focused rather than add-on features to legacy platforms. Salesforce, Oracle and Adobe have built new platforms that run in parallel to the existing tools. This points the way toward revolution, not evolution.

Agents Are Infused Across Platforms

The B2B MAP market is continuing its AI transition from manual, copilot-assisted task execution to autonomous, goal-driven AI agents. These agents can independently plan, build audiences, construct customer journeys, and optimize multichannel campaigns. However, because unconstrained autonomy introduces brand safety and compliance risks, this execution must operate under strict human governance, including approval checkpoints, audit trails, and policy-based controls.

Every way a marketing team wants to integrate agents into their MAP solution is now possible. Those include out-of-the-box, custom built, from a partner ecosystem and from an external application through an MCP server.

The scale of expansion of agents in this market is best represented by the number of included out-of-the-box agents across the vendors in this research. Every vendor has at least one stand-alone agent available, but the number rises from five to eight to nine to over 100 per vendor. Most of these require some type of consumption pricing, credits or tokens, which is usually a mix of those included with a package plus an extra quantity purchased.

Truly incorporating agentic AI into marketing operations often requires the ability to build from scratch or customize prebuilt agents. Almost every vendor evaluated currently has an agent builder, or it is on their roadmap. For those marketers who need something else, but are not looking to build it, nearly half of these vendors offer agent exchanges with potentially thousands of agents built by partners and other technology providers. These ecosystems are managed and supported by vendors. For example, Oracle reviews partner agent templates with a 21-point enterprise readiness checklist and provides support for agents created from partner templates.

Finally, for the more sophisticated B2B organizations, at least six of these vendors allow access to their MAPs via MCP servers. This is a roadmap item for others. Marketers can connect LLMs, such as ChatGPT and Claude, to their MAPs and manage operations from the LLM side. The most extreme example of this in the vendor set is Salesforce, which has announced its entire platform as a headless option, with no requirement to log in to the platform at all.

Buying Groups Are the New B2B Standard

Traditional lead-based marketing is giving way to account-centric and buying-group-centric orchestration. Not account-based marketing (ABM), but account-centric marketing. Marketers need to target buyers the same way they buy. B2B buying decisions involve larger, multistakeholder committees. Gartner research says these groups average five to 12 people.² There is no reason that marketing's digital capabilities are not used to discover and engage the buying group, rather than qualify and pass off a single lead to sales. The latter approach requires sales to expand its outreach from that lead to the buying group in a more manual way.

As CMOs and their teams change their focus from leads to buying groups, they need platforms that treat accounts as primary objects, not mere roll-ups of lead activity and engagement. AI is central to identifying buying group members, mapping their distinct organizational roles (e.g., procurement, engineering, finance) or buying roles (e.g., economic buyer, technical buyer, champion, recommender), scoring account-level buying intent, and coordinating content across channels to drive consensus.

Every vendor reviewed has the capability to manage and market to buying groups. This was an emerging capability last year, and only a few vendors we evaluated had it. Its growth across vendors is a strong indicator that B2B CMOs are looking for technology to manage buying group engagement. Strategy leads technology, and when all technology moves together, this indicates a change in the strategy of their customers. It is also a clear signal that marketers are looking at doing things differently as lead flow decreases and markets become more competitive.

This demand for changing technology to support shifts in strategy is upending MAPs more than expected. Legacy platforms were built around the concept of managing around single leads. Rather than rebuilding that core technology, several large vendors have delivered associated products to serve buying groups. Adobe has AJO-B2B, which runs along with Marketo and Real-Time CDP. Oracle has Fusion Marketing, which runs along with Eloqua. And Salesforce has Marketing Cloud Next, which has replaced Account Engagement. This approach works when the new platform has enough capabilities so it can replace the old platform, but it becomes challenging when the transition requires running multiple applications concurrently.

Answer Engines Can Shape Demand

AEO is now a required capability for MAPs as traditional SEO declines, AI-driven buyer research surges, and marketers need visibility into LLM research and AI model

recommendations. Leading MAPs must natively support closed-loop AEO workflows, leveraging deep customer data to generate, publish, and measure AI-optimized content, ensuring brands secure early and lasting visibility in AI-powered buyer journeys.

The traditional approach of lead and demand generation by B2B marketers starts with engagement at the top of the funnel. Even when expanded to buying group engagement, the task is still to create awareness at the top of the funnel and provide content that supports early-stage buying jobs. This is a primary function of MAPs. Today's top-of-the-funnel discovery activities by buyers have been taken over by LLMs and other AI answer engines (see [Unified Search: Integrating SEO, AEO and GEO to Improve Visibility](#)). Content hiding behind landing page forms to educate potential buyers is not found nor ingested by the answer engines. That means it is not provided as the answer to buyers' questions.

CMOs must adopt technology platforms that understand this new world of AI discovery. That may include AI agents to review web pages for LLM visibility and provide content recommendations. This transition has an impact on the content itself. Email may still be the leading B2B channel for engagement; however, unless a brand shows up earlier in the buying stage with an AI answer to contextual prompts, that email generates less of a response.

Shaping demand is meant to spark customer interest in future offerings by those not currently in the market for specific solutions. Marketing teams need to teach customers how to identify unmet, underappreciated or unknown business challenges, so the appropriate solutions are part of the consideration set when a buying need or opportunity occurs. Targeted content must now adopt machine-consumable formats, rich metadata, clean taxonomies, modular components and AI-native knowledge graphs to shape demand through answer engines (see [Engage Prospective B2B Buyers Before They Are In-Market](#)).

Only HubSpot and Salesforce have adopted answer engine optimization into their MAP, which limits the success of B2B marketers who need to make answer engines a core demand generation channel. They both target the same universe of buyers trying to solve the same pain points. Marketing teams must be able to anticipate buyers' prompts to properly understand LLM visibility. A good example of buyer intent language is a head-to-head comparison between top competitors, even in early buying or prebuying stages.

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